A Helping Hand

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/34674832.

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Explicit

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Airplane Sex, Exhibitionism, Edging, Wandering Hands, Adora Is Nervous, Catra Is Helpful, Strangers, Stranger Sex, Flirting

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A Helping Hand

by MxSinshine

Summary

Adora is nervous on airplanes, but a beautiful passenger next to her is there to help her relax her way through it. Sometimes a helping hand, even from a stranger, is all one really needs.

Notes

Hey all!I was traveling this week and needed to find a way to pass the time on the plane. And well... Hope you enþy!

Adora rushes towards her gate, after checking one of the large monitors to make absolutely *certain* that her flight is still running on time. Just as when she checked a few minutes prior, it's still departing from Gate A22, at the far end of the concourse of the godforsaken hellscape known as the airport. She power walks down the moving sidewalk that leads there, weaving in and out between the other patrons. It is frustrating to have to do so;doesn't everyone know to stand on the right to allow moving traffic to pass by on the left? Basic courtesy gets left behind in the bins at security, Adora swears.

Still once her departure gate comes into view, she allows herself to slow from an almost-jog down to frantic stroll. Adora sighs upon her arrival to the waiting area, both in relief and in irritation. Almost every seat is already taken, save for a few rows in the back, far away from where they will actually board the plane. This is absolutely the repercussion of not arriving to the airport the recommended full two hours early, but at least there is somewhere that she can wearily plop herself into for the next ninety five minutes.

Once seated, Adora double checks herself- one personal item, well below the maximum size and thus should fit under the seat in front of her with no issue. She is an efficient packer and was able to avoid a checked bag entirely;that will go in the overhead bin. Her combination neck pillow and travel blanket are still looped around the handle of her carry-on suitcase, the rainbow unicorn print not quite magical enough to make her smile at the moment. It is loud, it is congested, and she is suitably on edge for the most harrowing part of her journey home: the actual flight itself.

"Hey, I'm," Adora says into the phone, trying to keep her voice down so as to not disturb anyone around her, especially given the late hour of her red-eye flight. She's pretty sure her voice won't be discernible from the rest of the chatter that envelops the waiting area, but there is someone possibly asleep next to her. They've got their maroon leather jacket spread over them like a blanket and a baseball cap over their face, likely trying to pretend that they're

anywhere else in the world right now. Adora can't really blame them, even if she has no idea how anyone could *rest* in such an environment. "Yeah, I made it to the gate okay. No, security line wasn't bad today- shut up, I did not get *frisked*. That was one time and I just forgot about my belt-. Yeah, yeah. Two ladies patting me down is the perfect way to end a trip to Sin City. Real dream come true."

Adora rolls her eyes heavily and lets her bestie continue to chatter at her, Glimmer enjoying the opportunity to help Adora relive her worst travel moments. Her friend was there for most of them, so knowing that they suffered together through missed flights and trying to sleep under fluorescent lights in truly boring and ugly airports is why she is able to keep her teeth gnashing to a minimum. Someone really should get around to inventing instant teleportation. Hell of a lot more convenient.

"Group 2," The blonde says forlornly in reply to the question she's asked, frowning a little. She was meticulous with her check-in time, but most passengers must have paid the up-charge to get the chance to board the plane early. It's fine. It's all open seating anyway and the important thing is that she's on the craft. Adora has earned the next three days of recovery in her own bed, away from people and in the comforting embrace of her jammies. It was a beautiful wedding- Mara and Hope deserve only the best, but as happy as she is for her found family, Adora will be glad to be home.

"Well, it seemed stupid to pay an extra twenty five dollars. We're all getting on the flight eventually, so what does it really matter?" The person next to her stirs, stretching their legs out. Adora wouldn't have noticed the readjustment at all if the person's foot hadn't hit her own. She startles at the unexpected touch, flinching away and managing to knock into her suitcase. It doesn't fall, but Adora squeaks as she fumbles to catch it and Glimmer doesn't miss the sound. "What? No, I'm fine. Well, I mean, yes, of course I'm nervous. You know I hate to fly, but that was just my bag almost falling. Everything is fine."

And it’s technically true, even if Adora feels wound *way* too tight to have nearly a fraction of the ease she’s trying to convince her friend she has. Jimmer clucks her tongue on the other end of the phone and offers all the solid platitudes that have never worked to reassure Adora even once. But by this point, just like this entire phone call to her best friend, it is part of Adora’s pre-flight ritual.

As Jimmer runs through the statistics of how unlikely a fatal plane crash truly is, Adora glances to her left, ready to apologize for the social faux pas of unintended physical contact with a stranger. She immediately squeaks again, this time unable to assure Jimmer of her well-being. The woman has sat up, the cap no longer covering her face, and is looking back at Adora. Her eyes are a little tired, but not even travel fatigue is enough to lessen their beauty. One a bright, startlingly blue and the other a sweet honey amber, each of them with the power to completely dismantle Adora’s shred of calm, especially when paired with the dusting of freckles across a cute little nose and perfectly curved lips that might just be smiling *at her* and-
…

Knowing that she’s broken a social covenant by merely sitting and staring at this gorgeous individual and by ignoring her friends' increasingly high pitched concern for her over the phone, Adora swallows thickly and just manages to chokes out a “Sorry.” She is wooden as she turns away from the stranger, hand that is not holding her phone *gripping* into the top of her thigh for dear life. Adora has never once been quite so struck by a person, never had her flight response triggered by a handsome face. It is completely disarming.

“What are you sorry for? I hit you.”

The gentle rasp of the woman leaves Adora only able to meekly shrug in response. She is trying her best to not turn her head and risk ogling the stranger like a creep once again. She knows she cant balance both a conversation with Jimmer and reconcile the fact she’s seated next to a complete and total hottie, but Adora cant

quite remember how to close out a phone conversation. She's not even certain if she's replied to Glimmer in the last several minutes.

Life is made up of choices and Adora eventually stumbles through hers. "Hahah! Yup, feeling just fine. Um, we're gonna be boarding soon so-...no! I'll be fine, I swear. I am *not acting weird*, just being cool, as per my use." Adora wants to lay out across the nearest runway by this point. When has she ever abbreviated the word 'usual' in her life? "Ahem, ah, well looks like there's less than an hour to kill now, so ummm, brunch Sunday? Okay? Love to! Bow, bye Glimmer!"

Adora hurries to end the call, knowing full well she's going to have a lot more at breakfast to go over than wedding stories and showing off pictures. Glimmer was certainly confused by that stuttered exchange and Adora can't say she blames her friend. But having this attractive person right next to her seemed like the more pressing crisis to contend with.

"Mmm, you are a little nervous, aren't you?" Adora gulps at the silky words, clenching more than just her fingers by this point. Two little slips of paper flutter into her lap as a waft of spicy cologne hits her nose. The woman has stood up. "Here. Relax. And find me later."

Adora doesn't look at what has been given to her until well after the stunning stranger has departed. She doesn't have the motor skills to pick up the item, let alone the ability to comprehend the written language on them. But once she does regain a fraction of her sensibilities, Adora registers that they are tickets for a free beverage on their upcoming flight or at the airline's exclusive lounge. She isn't much of a drinker, but a liquid libation to steady her nerves seems prudent. *Find her later?!*

One for now and one for in flight the blonde decides. Adora gathers her luggage and in a daze follows the signs that lead to the premier lounge. She almost expects to be tackled to the ground the moment she steps foot into the private area, but she is able to present her ticket at the bar with no issue. It is much quieter in here and the

amaretto based cocktail in her glass is a perfect blend of sour and sweet.

The little time she has remaining before they board the plane trickles away as qickly as her drink does. Adora can firmly say this is as relaxed as she's ever been walking down the ramp to get on craft that will carry her over the land for the next four hours, though her stomach falls when she crosses into the interior of the plane. Nearly all the seats up front are filled, though that was to be expected. She tries to not make it obvious that she's scanning each aisle, looking for a tousle of short, brown hair and tawny skin. Adora has given up by the time the passengers are spread out amongst the seats, chalking the entire exchange up to her own silliness. In fact, she probably jst imagined that the woman had even said to find her-...

In nearly the very back, at least three rows away from any other passengers, Adora spots her. She is still jst as breathtaking in the low light of the mundane airplane cabin as she was at the gate. Adora wets her lips and sqares her shoulders, before walking towards the back of the craft. Her hands shake only a little as she methodically stows her carry-on in the bin above and settles into the seat next to the person that gifted her a free drink. It is only a two person row so their arms brush briefly as Adora situates herself for the long flight ahead. The woman doesnt say a word as the blonde removes her headphones and loops her neck pillow behind her, though Adora is fairly certain she hears a low chuckle once the matching blanket is spread out over her lap. She gets cold jst sitting for hours on end.

Adora is methodical in her preparations and it is all to cover the frantic beating of her heart. So many other seats she could have chosen to sit in;what was she thinking being so bold as to sit next to this stranger?Adora is so fixated on how unlike her this is to do that she nearly misses all of the safety briefings. It is only when she feels the plane lift off the ground that she remembers to be frightened.

She has both armrests in an iron grip, forgetting that etiqette dictates that one should belong to the passenger in the window seat.

The woman still hasn't said a word, isn't even looking Adora's way as they ascend into the sky. She faces the window to watch the inky darkness swallow the lights of the city they're leaving behind.

It is only once the craft levels out and the fasten seatbelt sign is turned off that Adora releases her tight hold on the armrest. This is the part of flying that she's surprisingly okay with- barring any turbulence or glimpses of the ground below her. It is part of why she prefers the red-eye, even if Adora knows she won't be sleeping tonight and will be dead to the world tomorrow. At least she can't make out the ground below them in the dark.

"Feeling better?"

Adora jumps at the question, just about to turn on some music and at least try to relax as they hurtle forward thousands of feet up in the air. She's not expecting it, but her chest buzzes with excitement as she answers. "Yes! Much, thanks to you. You really didn't have to-"…

"My pleasure." The brunette finishes smoothly and returns to watching out the darkened window to her right.

Adora bites her lip after a few seconds of silence and decides that she can always reseat herself if this all ends up being inside her head or unwanted in any way. "I really appreciate it. I hope it didn't cost you much."

"No, I fly frequently enough that they're very free with those drink tickets. I'm more than happy to share them." The woman turns her head towards her and smirks. "Especially with beautiful women."

Adora's mind is wiped clear on the spot and she's certain she's back to gaping. She fidgets with the blanket laid across her lap, bunching and pulling at the fleecy material. *What the fuck is she supposed to do with that?* It is a good thing she is not seated in the emergency exit row because Adora can't guarantee that she wouldn't have flung herself out the hatch by now if she had the chance.

"It does come at a price though."

"Mmmph?" It is the closest to actual language that Adora can get to.

"I like to know the names of the people I'm buying for."

Oh. This alluring stranger that may have just implied that she would classify Adora as a beautiful woman wants to know her name. Seems to want to have a conversation, even if they have to keep their voices down so as to not disturb the people trying to sleep several rows in front of them. With a gulp she breathes out, "... Adora. My name's Adora."

"Adora," Her name rolls off the woman's tongue, low and throaty. "Have a drink with me?"

It is late, the plane is low-lit and save for the rumble of the engines, surprisingly quiet. This is the closest to a date that Adora has had in months. She pushes that thought off, not wanting hope to get in the way of what could just be a way to pass a long flight. Still, she can't hide the excitement in her voice as she responds. "Yes! I still have one. I saved it." Adora produces the slip of paper allotting her a free beverage, holding it out proudly.

The chuckle her beverage benefactor gives is near musical. "Unnecessary, but what'll you have?"

Adora sticks with the same, an amaretto sour, and doesn't recognize what the other woman has ordered. It's dark in color and comes in a fancy glass and just feels sophisticated, far more than her own. But that doesn't matter because she's having a drink. A drink with-… "Um, do I get your name too?"

"Do you want it?" Adora's not sure if the question is meant to be a challenge, but *fuck*, the wink that accompanies it leaves her wanting a lot more than the woman's name.

"Yes. *Please*." Maybe the desperation in her tone will be lost under the sound of the engines propelling them along.

"Such good manners." The woman cooly remarks before indulging in a sip from her glass. Adora isn't sure she's going to answer, but the mystery is also pretty sexy, and this person's business is her own. She's already shown such kindness... "Catra."

"Thank you, Catra." Adora breathes out, thrill shooting through her stomach. *She has a name.*

"You're welcome, Adora." The pair fall silent for a while, content to finish their drinks as the plane brings them to their destination. Adora is a bit disappointed when there's nothing but ice left in her glass, but she's also pretty certain her cheeks are a little rosy. Probably for the best to stop now. She doesn't want to.

The outside of Catra's knee hits her own and Adora again startles at the touch. This time when she flinches, she doesn't jerk away and fuck, neither does Catra. The brunette seems full at ease in her seat, passively looking out the window and seemingly paying no mind to the trembling blonde next to her. Though her murmur cuts through the quiet easily. "Still nervous?"

Adora gives a noncommittal shake of her head. The answer is *yes, incredibly* though for once the flight is the furthest thing from her mind. Catra has left her entirely unhinged and is the only thing Adora can think about. "Maybe a little."

Her voice is small, so much that she can't even be sure Catra heard it. That is until Adora hears a soft, assessing hum from the person seated next to her.

Catra's hand has now moved from the armrest, likely because Adora can't find a place to put her own arm and is disrupting her. She's fidgeting; wringing her fingers together, then playing with the empty glass that the flight attendant hasn't picked up yet. Adora really has no need for her blanket this flight, Catra's mere presence combined

with a dose of alcohol is more than enough to leave her feeling heated, but the material is soft and comforting between her fingers. She really ought to find some activity, some way to entertain herself for the remaining duration of the flight. But then Catra's hand is between them on the seat, the woman's thumb just barely brushing her as they sit and Adora knows *she won't be able to focus on anything else*.

"Where's home?" The brunette asks, completely at ease even amongst these casual touches.

"Mmm, ummm, Bright Moon," Adora stutters, almost forgetting where the apartment she rents is located. Catra's hand has now moved so three of her fingers rest on the outside of Adora's leg. Adora shifts in her seat reflexively, holding her breath when she realizes that might come across as her trying to *pull away*. Nothing could be further from the truth, it's just that the area between her legs has just announced it needs attention and Adora is *barely hanging on here*.

"Neighbors, then."

"Oh? Oh!" Adora squeaks as Catra's hand moves up to settle firmly on the top of her thigh. Her attention snaps down to its presence beneath the blanket, verifying that what is happening is indeed really happening. The fingers pause, a clear question of whether they are welcomed there. Adora doesn't know what their end game is, but she figures replying is the best way to show she's far, far from uncomfortable in this situation. "*I like that.* I mean, uh, g-good to know!"

"Really now?" Catra's rasp is amused as she begins tracing patterns along Adora's leggings. Her hand is still on Adora's thigh, still covered by the blanket and the dim lighting of the airplane cabin. She leans in towards Adora's seat as she whispers, "I like it too."

Adora tries to turn her low moan into a cough that has her sinking down into her seat. *Fuck*. Her head is now practically on Catra's

shoulder and she quickly readjusts, sitting upright in her seat. Catra's hand has now retreated for the moment and Adora's mind whirls trying to think of how she can get it to come back. It is enthralling, this new touch, and she wants more of it.

"Now, where were we?" Adora hasn't really regained herself yet and that is only intensified when Catra leans over once more. Her mouth is curved up into a pointed smile, her eyes flashing even in the dim light. "Gotta keep quiet, though. Wouldn't want anyone to *hear you*."

Adora's whimper is muffled as she presses her lips together, Catra's hand returning to her leg. Except this time it's decidedly closer to being squarely on the inner part of her thigh and Adora feels like she could run the rest of the way home. Every nerve ending in her body is firing off in response to this new, exciting presence achingly close to a very sensitive area. Adora is soaked by this point, not even caring that this will end with her awkwardly changing her underwear in the airport bathroom before Bow drives her home. She packed extra; it will be fine.

"Same city." Adora breathlessly supplies, eyelids fluttering as her body twitches under Catra's exploratory graze. "Neighbors."

"Mmm, yes, that's right. Such a small world. I travel a lot as I said before, but there's something so satisfying about coming home." Adora has parted her legs as much as the seat allows, careful to make sure no part of her is in the aisle. No attendants have passed by recently, all of them seem to be hanging up at the front, but the last thing she needs is for anyone to interrupt what she thinks is about to happen. Or for anyone else to know at all. "It just feels so *good*."

"Uhuh." Adora is lost as Catra's hand moves along the entire length of her inner thigh, pausing right before she reaches the top. Her breath hitches as the woman's fingers arch upwards so that her rounded nails scratch against her just right. Adora wants to move down in her seat so that the woman's hand stops *teasing* her already, but also she's not ready to hurry this experience. Catra can

take her time, if she even wants to take things further that is. Adora does. "So, so good."

Their small talk dwindles but the heat from Catra touching her, even outside of her clothes, only increases. Finally Catra shows mercy and Adora has to bury her face into her neck pillow to cover her moan once Catra's hand slides underneath her leggings. Her fingers start to trace along her damp underwear and Adora feels a fresh wave of wetness hit her. Her breaths are coming fast and shallow, head spinning with the repeated thought that she *doesn't do this* . But when Catra applies a little pressure and Adora has to bite down on her tongue to keep from crying out, she's sure as hell happy she has.

Adora can feel the pad of the woman's fingers move along her and her cunt responds in turn, aching for relief from this tortuous build. Her leg jerks as Catra' s movements grow bolder and a shaky sigh escapes her. It is so good, all heightened from the fact that anyone could catch them at any moment. That would be so embarrassing, but it's not nearly enough to curb Adora's desire.

"Do you want me to stop?" The words are said directly into her ear , Catra so close that if Adora were to turn her head, their lips would absolutely brush. Somehow that thought feels more intimidating than the fact she's got a stranger's hand down her pants in semi-public. Adora's priorities are a little skewed at the moment.

With great effort and control to keep from crying out, Adora shakes her head and asserts, "More."

She hears a satisfied inhale that Adora is certain is paired with a sharp smirk, but her eyes are closed as she focuses on the feeling of Catra's fingers against her. Her panties are still a cotton barrier between them, but the woman's fingers are skilled as they move. Adora is rigid in her seat, trying so hard to not rock herself down on Catra's hand, knowing that would be a dead giveaway to their barely concealed tryst.

Following Adora's direction, Catra slowly parts her panties away from her slick center, with a soft sigh of contentment. And fuck does it feel good;her movements are gentle, exploring, and hesitant only so much to allow Adora the chance to end this should it prove to be too much. It is not too much. It is perfect.

"Not inside."Adora directs before surrendering herself to the flick of Catra's finger against her needy clit. She has to focus on not being loud, which normally isn't a problem for her . She would have never called herself particularly vocal in bed but whether it is the thrill that they could be discovered at any moment or just that Catra is that fucking good, Adora wishes she could be *screaming* right now. Instead she'll have to settle for the occasional belabored huff as her toes curl from how Catra swirls her fingers against her. She won't last long like this.

"You're doing so good here."Catra murmurs, a tiny edge to her voice, the only thing that betrays that her reassurance has nothing to do with Adora's fear of flying. Her fingers speed up and Adora has her head thrown back with her mouth parted, at least so much as the stupid pillow allows. "So relaxed for me."

Relaxed?Adora is completely on edge with Catra's hand working expertly against her. Just when she thinks relief will come, the woman backs away from her clit or slows down to the barest flicker. She tries to breathe evenly through her nose, aware that any provocative sounds she makes would be instantly recognizable in the quiet cabin. Catra knows this and only continues to build her up higher and higher. Adora is certain she's never been this turned on in her life, confirmed with how easily Catra glides through her folds and how she throbs around the woman's fingers. Once or twice she hears a sensual moan of appreciation from the woman next to her, but the sound is low and just for her .

Adora is gripping the bottom of her seat for dear life, so ready to let go but also never wants the pleasure to end. But the pressure is just right for just long enough and Adora comes. Blessedly , it is silent. Her body shakes as Catra works her through her ripples and the only

sound she makes is one long slow breath that she hopes passes as a sleepy sigh. Catra's fingers slow but remain against her clit, circling until Adora is biting her lip and near panting. Just when she thinks she can't handle how good it feels any longer, the other woman departs. She feels Catra wipe her fingers along the blanket that shielded them so well and shivers as her hot breath hits Adora's ear again. "Would have rather licked them clean."

That alone is enough to make Adora beg for round two, but before she can even whimper, the loudspeaker echoes through the plane.

"*Attention passengers, we will now be turning on the cabin lights. We anticipate touching the ground at Bright Moon International Airport in approximately fifteen minutes. Please remain seated. Seatbelt signs have been turned on.*"

"That's not the only thing that's been turned on." Catra jokes, blinking as her eyes adjust to the jarring influx of light around them. She shifts in her seat for a moment, a knowing smile across her face.

Only the words and their meaning catch up to Adora and she now wishes the flight was twice as long. Because as good as it felt to have Catra touch her, what if Adora had gotten to... "Oh. *Fuck*, I'm sorry, I-..."

"Back to needlessly apologizing? Thought we were past that, all things considered." Catra smirks and shakes her head for a moment before her face grows serious. However, her eyes are kind, almost fond in a way that Adora can't quite explain. But given how quickly things have escalated between them, it feels completely right. "It was my pleasure, truly. Hopefully my company made things a little more… *enjoyable* for your flight."

Adora passes a hand over her face and laughs, a high, shuddering sound that she barely recognizes. Of course, she barely recognizes herself at this moment. It is an all-around good feeling. "Best fucking flight of my life."

"I'm sure the captain will be pleased to hear it. W ell be landing soon."Catra turns to watch their descent from the window and Adora is left boneless in her seat, heart thudding in her chest, trying to come down from one of the most sensational highs of her life. She is so distracted that she barely registers when the plane touches the ground once more, easily the worst part of any flight. How could she possibly be nervous that the plane wont actually be able to stop on the runway with the memories of Catra's fingers rubbing her clit so clear in her mind?

Catra. Adora still cant believe that such a captivating and tantalizing person such as herself would even give Adora the time of day. Things like this just dont happen in real life;beautiful strangers offering her drinks before giving her the best orgasm of her life. She thinks she ought to say something, thank the woman somehow, but they remain quiet all the way up until the plane is docked and they're free to carry about their lives. Catra stands and somehow manages to get herself into the aisle without Adora needing to move much. It is a good thing, because she's not sure she can quite yet. She' s in a pleasant daze, suitably exhausted from the flight and other activities of the night and it takes her a moment to really register that Catra has relocated her position. The thought jolts her awake, a low thrum of alarm hitting her. Catra cant go, not yet.

"W ait!Can I get your numb-"…

Another piece of paper falls into her lap before Catra strolls down the narrow aisle of the craft and away from her. But the ten digits scrawled on the slip tell Adora that it wont be for long.

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